

## Configuring Winlogbeat

Once the installation process is completed, we need to configure the *config* file (.yml file) to send the captured logs from Windows to Elasticsearch. Open the configuration file, *winlogbeat.yml*, which is present in the directory where the zip file is extracted.

In that file, scroll down to the *output* *elasticsearch* section and uncomment that part (*output.elasticsearch*, hosts, user name and password).

Make sure your host is set to what you configured while configuring Elasticsearch. By default, it is *localhost:9200*. Enter the user name and password of the 'elastic' user, which you might have generated after installing Elasticsearch.

After configuring, the output should look similar to what is shown in Figure 2.

Now we need to configure the *setup.kibana* part in the same file. Uncomment that part, and make sure the host is set properly to the one you configured while installing Kibana. For getting all the logs in a neat visualised format, make sure *setup.dashboards.enabled* is set to true in the same file. Refer to Figure 3.

Next, we will modify the *winlogbeat.event\_logs* section in the same file. We need to mention which services are to be monitored. By default, it has three services — application, security and system. You can leave it as default or you can add any if needed according to your use case.

Once everything is done, run the command given below in PowerShell (same directory) to save the configurations:

```
.\winlogbeat.exe test config -c .\
winlogbeat.yml -e
```

Once you have successfully executed the command to save, load the assets for data visualisation, and run the command:

```
.\winlogbeat.exe setup -e
```

```
# ----- Elasticsearch Output -----
output.elasticsearch:
  # Array of hosts to connect to.
  hosts: ["localhost:9200"]

  # Protocol - either 'http' (default) or 'https'.
  #protocol: "https"

  # Authentication credentials - either API key or username/password.
  #api_key: "id:api_key"
  username: "elastic"
  password: "elastic"
```

Figure 2: Output of Elasticsearch configuration

```
# ----- Dashboards -----
# These settings control loading the sample dashboards to the Kibana index. Loading
# the dashboards is disabled by default and can be enabled either by setting the
# options here or by using the 'setup' command.
setup.dashboards.enabled: true

# The URL from where to download the dashboards archive. By default this URL
# has a value which is computed based on the Beat name and version. For released
# versions, this URL points to the dashboard archive on the artifacts.elastic.co
# website.
#setup.dashboards.url:

# ----- Kibana -----

# Starting with Beats version 6.0.0, the dashboards are loaded via the Kibana API.
# This requires a Kibana endpoint configuration.
setup.kibana:

  # Kibana Host
  # Scheme and port can be left out and will be set to the default (http and 5601)
  # In case you specify and additional path, the scheme is required: http://localhost:5601/path
  # IPv6 addresses should always be defined as: https://[2001:db8::1]:5601
  host: "localhost:5601"

  # Kibana Space ID
  # ID of the Kibana Space into which the dashboards should be loaded. By default,
  # the Default Space will be used.
  #space.id:
```

Figure 3: Kibana dashboard configuration

| Services (Local)    |                                |                   |         |                  |     |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|---------|------------------|-----|
| winlogbeat          |                                |                   |         |                  |     |
| Stop the service    | Name                           | Description       | Status  | Startup Type     | Log |
| Restart the service | Windows Mixed Reality Op...    | Enables Mix...    |         | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | Windows Mobile Hotspot Se...   | Provides the...   |         | Manual (Trigg... | Loc |
|                     | Windows Modules Installer      | Enables inst...   |         | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | Windows Perception Service     | Enables spat...   |         | Manual (Trigg... | Loc |
|                     | Windows Perception Simulat...  | Enables spat...   |         | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | Windows Presentation Foun...   | Optimizes p...    | Running | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | Windows Push Notifications...  | This service r... | Running | Automatic        | Loc |
|                     | Windows PushToInstall Servi... | Provides infr...  |         | Manual (Trigg... | Loc |
|                     | Windows Remote Managem...      | Windows Re...     |         | Manual           | Ne  |
|                     | Windows Search                 | Provides con...   | Running | Automatic (De... | Loc |
|                     | Windows Security Service       | Windows Se...     | Running | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | Windows Time                   | Maintains d...    | Running | Automatic (De... | Loc |
|                     | Windows Update                 | Enables the ...   |         | Manual (Trigg... | Loc |
|                     | Windows Update Medic Ser...    | Enables rem...    |         | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | WinHTTP Web Proxy Auto-D...    | WinHTTP im...     | Running | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | winlogbeat                     |                   | Running | Automatic (De... | Loc |
|                     | Wired AutoConfig               | The Wired A...    |         | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | WLAN AutoConfig                | The WLANs...      | Running | Automatic        | Loc |
|                     | WMI Performance Adapter        | Provides per...   |         | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | Work Folders                   | This service ...  |         | Manual           | Loc |
|                     | Workstation                    | Creates and ...   | Running | Automatic        | Ne  |

Figure 4: Winlogbeat service status

This completes the setup part. It's time to start the *winlogbeat*. Use the following command to start Winlogbeat

(in the same directory in PowerShell):

```
Start-Service winlogbeat
```